

Computer science and disabilities

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Many people with disabilities rely on technology developed by computer scientists to help them with everything from reading and speaking, to developing their own technology.

Independence

Computer science is used in a variety of technologies that help people with disabilities. Some of these technologies – such as hearing aids or screen readers – are specifically designed to assist people with disabilities. Others are developments that everyone uses regardless of ability level, such as online shopping sites and speech recognition. As a whole, these technologies allow people with disabilities to have more independence and also to take part fully in schools and workplaces.

► Assistive technologies

Assistive technologies help people overcome problems they face as a result of their disability. One example is an environmental control unit (ECU) that lets people with mobility problems control items in their house using a smartphone. Other examples help blind or deaf people communicate with those around them.



Speech recognition system / screen reader



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